

Absolutely — **good** is one of those deceptively ordinary words that becomes extremely rich once we run the full polysemy and family audit.

Word family: **good / better / best / goodness / goods / goodwill**

Base word: good

Comparative: better

Superlative: best

Related forms: goodness

Useful lexical extensions: goods, goodwill

Part of speech: mainly adjective (形容詞), also noun-related uses (名詞相關用法)

Your sentence:

> “He showed me that a **good question** could open a door...”

Here **good** means:

> **effective, thoughtful, useful, and capable of leading to deeper understanding**

It does **not** simply mean 「好的」 in a vague sense.

Meaning in your passage: **good + question (問題) — 有質素、能啟發思考的**

A **good question** here is one that:

- * is meaningful;
- * encourages thinking;
- * helps reveal something important;
- * leads to deeper understanding.

繁體中文：

有思考價值、能引導人深入理解或發現新觀點的

Natural translation:

> “He showed me that a good question could open a door...”

「他讓我明白，一個**有啟發性、值得思考的好問題**可以打開一道門.....」

So here:

> **good question = 有質素、能引發思考和進一步理解的問題**

1. **good + thing/product/work (質素) — 優質的 ; 表現良好的**

One of the core meanings.

Practice 1

> “This is a **good book** for beginners.”

「這是一本對初學者來說**質素不錯、很適合閱讀的書**。」

Practice 2

> “She did a **good job** on the presentation.”

「她的簡報做得**很好 / 質素很高**。」

good = 質素、表現或完成程度達到令人滿意甚至優秀水平的

This broad sense covers many objects and results.

2. **good + question/idea/point/reason (內容 / 思考價值) — 有道理的 ; 有價值的 ; 有啟發性的**

This is your original branch.

Practice 3 — Original

> “A **good question** could open a door.”

「一個**有啟發性、值得深入思考的問題**可以打開一道門。」

Practice 4

> “That is a **good point**.”

「那是一個**很有道理、值得注意的觀點**。」

Practice 5

> “She gave a **good reason** for changing the plan.”

「她提出了一個**合理而有說服力的理由**來更改計劃。」

****good — idea/question/reason = 在邏輯、價值、啟發性或實用性方面值得肯定的****

This is better treated as a contextual branch of “positive quality” rather than a completely unrelated lexical meaning.

3. **good + person/behaviour (道德) — 善良的；正直的；合乎道德的**

A genuinely different concept.

Practice 6

> “She is a genuinely ****good person****.”

「她是一個真正****善良、品格好的人****。」

Practice 7

> “He tried to do the ****good**** thing even when it was difficult.”

「即使很困難，他仍然努力做****正確、合乎道德的事****。」

****good — morality = 在品格、意圖或行為上善良、正直或符合道德標準的****

This is not about quality of workmanship.

4. **good at + activity/skill (能力) — 擅長……；在……方面表現好**

A major grammatical construction.

Practice 8

> “He was ****good at explaining**** difficult ideas.”

「他很****擅長解釋****困難的概念。」

Practice 9

> “She is ****good at history****.”

「她很****擅長歷史科 / 歷史很好****。」

****good at + activity/subject = 在某種技能、活動或學科方面具有較強能力****

5. ****good with + person/thing (相處 / 操作能力) — 很會應付；善於與.....相處 / 使用****

This deserves separate treatment because the construction changes the meaning usefully.

Practice 10

> “He is very ****good with children****.”

「他很****會跟孩子相處 / 很懂得應付孩子****。」

Practice 11

> “She is ****good with computers****.”

「她很****擅長使用和處理電腦相關問題****。」

****good with = 很懂得與某類人相處，或很會操作 / 處理某類事物****

6. ****good for + person/thing (有益) — 對.....有益；有好處****

Practice 12

> “Regular exercise is ****good for your health****.”

「定期運動****對健康有益****。」

Practice 13

> “Reading widely is ****good for your vocabulary****.”

「廣泛閱讀****有助於擴充詞彙****。」

****good for = 對某人的健康、發展、狀態或結果帶來正面效果****

7. ****good for + purpose/use (適合用途) — 適合用來.....；可用於.....****

This is related but distinct enough in learner use.

Practice 14

> “This room is **good for small meetings**.”

「這個房間**適合舉行小型會議**。」

Practice 15

> “These headphones are **good for travelling**.”

「這副耳機**很適合旅行時使用**。」

****good for = 適合某種用途、情境或活動****

Compare:

> good for your health

> = 對健康有益

> good for travelling

> = 適合旅行使用

8. ****good for + period/amount (有效 / 可維持) — 可維持..... ; 有效期為.....****

A useful practical use.

Practice 16

> “The ticket is **good for one day**.”

「這張票**有效一天**。」

Practice 17

> “The battery is **good for about ten hours**.”

「這顆電池大約**可使用十小時**。」

****good for + duration/amount = 在某段時間 / 數量範圍內仍然有效、可用或足夠****

9. ****good to + person (待人態度) — 對.....好 ; 善待.....****

Practice 18

> “He was always **good to his students**.”

「他總是**很好地對待學生 / 很關心學生**。」

Practice 19

> “She has been very **good to me**.”

「她一直**對我很好**。」

good to someone = 以友善、體貼、慷慨或關懷的態度對待某人

10. **good = suitable/acceptable/satisfactory (合適 / 可以) — 合適的 ; 可以的 ; 令人滿意的**

Very common conversationally.

Practice 20

> “Is Friday **good** for you?”

「星期五對你來說**方便 / 合適嗎**？」

Practice 21

> “Six o'clock sounds **good**.”

「六點聽起來**可以 / 很合適**。」

good = 某個時間、安排或選擇符合需要 , 因此可以接受 / 適合

This is not exactly “high quality.”

11. **good = pleasant/enjoyable (感受 / 經歷) — 愉快的 ; 令人享受的**

Practice 22

> “We had a **good time** at the reunion.”

「我們在聚會上**過得很開心**。」

Practice 23

> “It was a **good day**.”

「那是**愉快、順利的一天**。」

good = 某段經歷令人感到愉快、滿足或順利

Contextual branch of positive evaluation.

12. **good** = favourable/positive (結果 / 消息 / 情況) — 有利的；正面的；令人高興的

Practice 24

> “That’s **good news**.”

「那是**好消息 / 令人高興的消息**。」

Practice 25

> “The results were **good**.”

「結果**很理想 / 令人滿意**。」

good = 某個結果、情況或消息朝有利、理想或令人滿意的方向發展

13. **good** = healthy / in proper condition (身體 / 物件狀態) — 健康的；狀況良好的

Practice 26

> “His health is still **good**.”

「他的健康狀況仍然**良好**。」

Practice 27

> “The laptop is still in **good condition**.”

「這部手提電腦的狀況仍然**很好**。」

good = 身體、物件或系統保持正常、健康、沒有重大問題的狀態

14. **good = valid/reliable/strong enough (證據 / 理由 / 機會) — 充分的 ; 可靠的 ; 很大的**

Practice 28

> “There is **good evidence** that the method works.”

「有**相當可靠、充分的證據**顯示這個方法有效。」

Practice 29

> “There is a **good chance** that she will pass.”

「她有**很大的機會**通過。」

good = 在可靠性、充分程度或可能性方面達到相當高的水平

Natural Chinese often changes:

* good evidence → 有力 / 可靠證據

* good chance → 很大機會

15. **good = considerable / fairly large (數量 / 距離) — 相當大的 ; 不少的**

A less obvious but useful meaning.

Practice 30

> “It took a **good two hours** to finish.”

「完成它足足花了**兩個小時左右 / 相當完整的兩小時**。」

Practice 31

> “We walked a **good distance** before stopping.”

「我們走了**相當長的一段距離**才停下來。」

good = 用來強調數量、時間或距離相當大 / 充分

Common:

* a good few

* a good many
* a good ten minutes
* a good distance

16. **the good = what is morally right/beneficial (名詞化) — 善 ; 好處 ; 有益之事**

Practice 32

> “People often disagree about what counts as **the good**.”

「人們常常對甚麼才算是**善 / 真正的好**有不同看法。」

Practice 33

> “She always tries to see the **good** in people.”

「她總是嘗試看到別人身上的**優點 / 善意**。」

the good / good in someone = 有價值、正面或善良的部分

17. **for the good of + person/group (利益) — 為了.....的利益 / 福祉**

Practice 34

> “The decision was made **for the good of the students**.”

「這個決定是**為了學生的利益 / 福祉**而作出的。」

Practice 35

> “Sometimes individuals make sacrifices for the **common good**.”

「有時個人會為了**共同利益 / 公共福祉**作出犧牲。」

for the good of = 為了某人 / 群體長遠的利益和福祉

18. **no good = useless / ineffective / unsuitable — 沒用 ; 無效 ; 不合適**

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 36

> “This old charger is ****no good**** anymore.”

「這個舊充電器已經****沒用了 / 不能正常使用****。」

Practice 37

> “Arguing with him is ****no good****.”

「跟他爭論****沒有用****。」

****no good** = 沒有實際作用、效果或價值******

19. ****for good** = permanently — 永遠；永久地******

A highly useful fixed expression whose meaning cannot be inferred from ordinary ****good****.

Practice 38

> “She left the city ****for good****.”

「她****永久地 / 一去不返地****離開了這座城市。」

Practice 39

> “The shop closed ****for good**** last year.”

「那間店去年****永久結業****了。」

****for good** = 永久地，不再恢復原來狀態******

This is a fixed expression, not a new normal adjective sense.

20. ****as good as + adjective/verb result** (幾乎等同於) — 幾乎；實際上等於******

Practice 40

> “The project is ****as good as finished****.”

「這個項目****幾乎已經完成 / 實際上等同完成了****。」

Practice 41

> “Without the key, the device is **as good as useless**.”

「沒有那把鑰匙，這部裝置**幾乎等於完全沒用**。」

as good as = 在實際效果上幾乎等同於某種狀態

Useful fixed construction.

21. **good enough** = sufficiently good — 夠好；達到所需標準

Practice 42

> “The answer is **good enough** for this exercise.”

「這個答案對這項練習來說已經**夠好 / 達到要求**。」

Practice 43

> “The sound quality was not **good enough** for professional use.”

「音質**不夠好**，未達專業用途要求。」

good enough = 質素或程度已達到特定目的所需要的最低 / 適當標準

22. **better / best** (比較級 / 最高級) — 更好；最好

These are irregular forms of **good**.

Practice 44

> “This explanation is **better** than the first one.”

「這個解釋比第一個**更好**。」

Practice 45

> “That was the **best** lesson I had all year.”

「那是我全年上過**最好**的一堂課。」

****better = good 的比較級****

****best = good 的最高級****

Unlike regular adjectives:

> good → better → best

not:

> *gooder / goodest* ❌

23. ****goodness = quality of being good / moral goodness — 善良；優良；好處****

Practice 46

> “She believed in the basic ****goodness**** of people.”

「她相信人性本質上具有****善良的一面****。」

Practice 47

> “The story focuses on kindness and human ****goodness****.”

「故事集中描寫善意和人性的****善良****。」

****goodness = 善良、正面價值或「好」這種特質****

Most common modern use is moral/positive quality.

24. ****goods = products/items for sale (固定複數名詞) — 商品；貨物****

This is a very important lexicalized plural.

Practice 48

> “The company imports electronic ****goods****.”

「這家公司進口電子****商品 / 貨物****。」

Practice 49

> “The damaged ****goods**** were returned to the supplier.”

「受損的**貨物**被退回供應商。」

goods = 為出售、運輸或交易而存在的實體商品 / 貨物

Important:

> **goods** is not simply the ordinary plural of adjective **good**.

It is a separate lexicalized noun.

25. **goodwill = friendly/supportive attitude (善意) — 善意；友好關係**

A useful family extension.

Practice 50

> “The teacher built up a great deal of **goodwill** among students.”

「老師在學生之間建立了很多**好感和善意**。」

Practice 51

> “The apology helped restore **goodwill** between the two sides.”

「道歉有助恢復雙方之間的**善意和友好關係**。」

goodwill = 對某人 / 組織所持的友善、信任和正面態度

26. **goodwill = business value of reputation/customer relationships (商業 / 會計) — 商譽**

A distinct business meaning of the same word.

Practice 52

> “The company recorded **goodwill** after the acquisition.”

「公司在收購後記錄了一項**商譽**資產。」

Practice 53

> “Part of the purchase price reflected the brand’s **goodwill**.”

「部分收購價反映了品牌的**商譽價值**。」

goodwill — business/accounting = 企業因品牌、聲譽、客戶關係等無形因素所具有的額外商業價值

This is a useful professional meaning.

Important distinction: **good vs well**

Very important.

good

normally adjective:

> “She is a **good teacher**.”

「她是一位好老師。」

well

normally adverb:

> “She teaches **well**.”

「她教得很好。」

But **well** can also be an adjective meaning healthy:

> “I’m well.”

「我身體很好。」

So:

> **good teacher** 

> **teaches well** 

Important distinction: **good at vs good with**

good at

= skilled in an activity/subject

> good at maths

good with

= skilled at dealing with people/things

> good with children

> good with computers

Compare:

> “She is good at teaching.”

= 她擅長教學。

> “She is good with children.”

= 她很會跟孩子相處。

Important distinction: **good for vs good to**

good for

= beneficial/suitable

> “Exercise is good for you.”

「運動對你有益。」

good to

= kind toward someone

> “She is good to her students.”

「她對學生很好。」

One preposition changes the relationship completely.

Important distinction: **good vs nice**

good

very broad:

- * high quality;
- * morally positive;
- * effective;
- * suitable.

nice

often means:

- * pleasant;
- * enjoyable;
- * friendly.

> “He is a good teacher.”

usually evaluates his teaching quality.

> “He is a nice teacher.”

usually emphasizes that he is pleasant/friendly.

Important distinction: **good vs kind**

good person

broad moral evaluation.

kind person

specifically considerate/helpful toward others.

A person can be:

> kind but not especially competent

so **good** and **kind** are not synonyms in every context.

Important distinction: **good vs correct**

This matters in your passage.

> “That’s a good answer.”

can mean:

- * thoughtful;
- * useful;
- * well expressed.

It does **not necessarily mean**:

> “That’s the correct answer.”

= 答案客觀上正確。

So:

good answer ≠ automatically correct answer

Important distinction: **good vs effective**

good

broad positive evaluation.

effective

specifically achieves the intended result.

> “It was a good lesson.”

could mean enjoyable, useful, well taught.

> “It was an effective lesson.”

means it successfully achieved its teaching purpose.

Important distinction: **good vs high-quality**

high-quality

specifically evaluates quality.

good

can mean many other things:

- * moral;
- * useful;
- * suitable;
- * pleasant;
- * beneficial.

So **good** is much broader.

Important distinction: **good vs goods**

good

adjective:

> “a good product”

「好產品」

goods

noun:

> “consumer goods”

「消費品」

Do not interpret **goods** as simply “many good things.”

Important distinction: **goodwill — ordinary vs accounting**

Ordinary:

> goodwill between colleagues

= 同事之間的善意 / 好感

Accounting:

> goodwill on a balance sheet

= 商譽這項無形資產

Same spelling, genuinely different professional meaning.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **good — quality** = 質素 / 表現良好
- * **good question/point/reason** = 有價值、有道理、有啟發性的
- * **good — moral** = 善良 / 正直
- * **good at** = 擅長
- * **good with** = 很會處理 / 相處
- * **good for — beneficial** = 對.....有益
- * **good for — suitable** = 適合.....
- * **good for — duration/validity** = 可維持 / 有效.....
- * **good to** = 善待 / 對.....好
- * **good — acceptable/suitable** = 合適 / 可以
- * **good — enjoyable** = 愉快的
- * **good — favourable** = 正面 / 有利
- * **good — healthy/condition** = 狀況良好
- * **good evidence/chance** = 充分 / 可靠 / 機會很大
- * **good + amount/distance** = 相當大的 / 不少的
- * **the good** = 善 / 正面部分
- * **for the good of** = 為.....利益
- * **no good** = 沒用 / 無效
- * **for good** = 永久地
- * **as good as** = 幾乎等同於
- * **good enough** = 達到所需標準
- * **better** = 更好
- * **best** = 最好
- * **goodness** = 善良 / 正面特質
- * **goods** = 商品 / 貨物
- * **goodwill — ordinary** = 善意 / 好感
- * **goodwill — business** = 商譽

This is a large family, but I would still avoid flooding it with transparent compounds such as **good-

looking, good-natured, good-hearted** unless a particular passage requires them.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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good — quality	質素、表現或完成程度達到令人滿意甚至優秀水平的
good question/idea/point	在思考價值、邏輯或啟發性方面值得肯定的
good — moral	在品格、意圖或行為方面善良、正直、符合道德標準的
good at	在某項技能、活動或學科方面具有較強能力
good with	很懂得與某類人相處，或很會操作 / 處理某類事物
good for — beneficial	對某人的健康、發展或結果帶來正面作用
good for — suitable	適合某種用途、情境或活動
good for — duration	在某段時間 / 數量範圍內仍然有效、可用或足夠
good to someone	以友善、體貼、關懷的方式對待某人
good — acceptable	某個安排、時間或選擇符合需要，因此合適 / 可以接受
good — enjoyable	某段經歷令人感到愉快、滿足或順利
good — favourable	某個結果、消息或情況朝正面、有利方向發展
good — condition	身體、物件或系統保持正常健康、沒有重大問題
good evidence/chance	在可靠性、充分程度或可能性方面達到相當高水平
good — considerable	用來強調數量、時間或距離相當大 / 充分
the good	道德上正確、正面或有益的事物 / 特質
for the good of	為某人 / 群體的利益或福祉
no good	沒有實際作用、效果或價值
for good	永久地；不再恢復原來狀態
as good as	在實際效果上幾乎等同於某種狀態
good enough	質素或程度已達特定用途所需標準
better / best	good 的不規則比較級 / 最高級
goodness	善良、正面價值或「好」的特質
goods	為出售、運輸或交易而存在的實體商品 / 貨物
goodwill — ordinary	對某人或組織所持的友善、信任和正面態度
goodwill — accounting	品牌、聲譽和客戶關係等帶來的額外無形商業價值

For your original sentence

> “He showed me that a **good question** could open a door...”

The exact meaning is:

good = 在思考價值和啟發性方面具有高質素，能引導人進一步理解某個問題的

So:

> **a good question**

= **「一個有啟發性、值得深入思考的問題」**

Natural translation:

> **「他讓我明白，一個有啟發性的好問題可以打開一道門。」**

The key nuance is that **good** here does not merely mean 「令人喜歡的」 or 「正確的」. A **good question** is one that **opens up thinking, reveals new angles, and helps people understand something more deeply**.